



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Corinth Grammar
School Website: <https://foundersclassical.com/corinth/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy – Corinth (K–5) Grammar Campus TX 75065 presents a clearly classical orientation in its public materials, with strong emphasis on virtuous character formation, liberal arts, and a partnership model with parents as co-educators. The campus script frames education as formation of the whole person—cultivating truth, goodness, and beauty through a liberal arts curriculum rooted in Western tradition, and through practices such as parent partnership and community engagement. This aligns with many core elements of classical education, notably the emphasis on formation, virtue, and a liberal-arts curriculum. However, while the school articulates several hallmark classical features (liberal arts, Trivium-related language, virtuous formation, parent partnership), certain explicit components that often accompany a fuller Classical framework (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation engagement, liturgical/theological integration, and clearly delineated contemplative pedagogy like scholé) are not consistently foregrounded in the publicly accessible material. Overall, the school demonstrates strong classical signals but with some gaps that prevent a clean CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

- Overall aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Key strength highlights:
- Explicit language of truth, beauty, goodness, virtue, formation, and the liberal arts in public materials (Cate. 1 & 2).
- Clear articulation of a liberal arts, Western-tradition curriculum (Latin, logic, philosophy, classic literature) and a culture of moral character and intellectual discipline (Cate. 3 & 5).
- Strong parent/community partnership orientation (co-educators) and public-facing focus on forming virtuous scholars (Cate. 6).
- Important opportunities to move toward full CLASSICAL status (where indicated as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL): explicit theology/ liturgical practices, formal inclusion of Great Books/Great Conversation in daily praxis, and more explicit scholé/restful pedagogy signals.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize truth, beauty, and goodness as foundational ideals: "tuition-free, K–5 classical education rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness" and "formed the whole person" with virtuous citizens. - Language around virtue and character is prominent ("wise and virtuous citizens"; formation of the whole person). - Clearly Western-tradition liberal arts orientation is stated ("Rigorous liberal arts curriculum grounded in Western tradition").

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (per the Six Elements lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formation, Western tradition, moral formation, virtue ethics, wisdom. - Negative keywords: not clearly present (no explicit signaling of relativism, secularism, or values-neutral approaches in the visible public materials).

Why this rating - The school foregrounds transcendental ideals (truth, goodness, beauty) and virtue formation, which are central to the religious/metaphysical axis of classical education. However, explicit grounding in theology, liturgical practices, or sacramental/communal worship signals are not clearly foregrounded in the public-facing materials reviewed here. The absence of explicit liturgical/theological integration places the category in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL, despite strong signals of moral realism and formation.

What would move the needle - Add explicit theology-grounding language or liturgical/community practices (e.g., daily chapel, liturgical calendar, sacred music) to establish a firmer theological/metaphysical grounding. - Include explicit references to the transcendental aims (logos, teleology, natural law) in public materials to strengthen the transcendental/metaphysical frame.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission language foregrounds formation and virtue: “Forming Scholars. Cultivating Virtue. Leading with Purpose.” and “education should elevate the mind and shape the soul,” with classical commitments. - Public statements tie education to virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of human excellence rather than mere workforce preparation: “a tradition that pursues knowledge, promotes virtue, and prepares students for lives of integrity, service, and liberty.” - Recurrent phrase: “rooted in truth, beauty, and goodness” as a core educational aim.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (implicit in formation toward virtue and integrity), truth/beauty/goodness, liberal education. - Negative keywords: not present in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on college/career readiness or skills-first framing).

Why this rating - The school's stated aim centers on formation, virtue, and the cultivation of human excellence, with explicit classical framing (liberal arts, Western tradition). This aligns closely with the classical ideal of education as formation toward the true, good, and beautiful, rather than merely job preparation. The rhetoric strongly supports CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Strengthen explicit articulation of telos through curriculum goals (e.g., clearly state aims like “formation of wisdom for human flourishing” and connect them to daily practice). - Tie Great Books/Great Conversation more explicitly to the core mission to reinforce the fullness of classical purposes.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit mention of a liberal arts curriculum with “Latin, logic, philosophy, and classic literature” as core study areas. - Public materials reference a Trivium-oriented framing (via links such as “Trivium Explained”), indicating engagement with the foundational grammar/logic/rhetoric progression. - The site highlights a commitments-based, liberal-arts curriculum anchored in Western tradition.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; with Latin listed), Trivium, classical literature, liberal arts, great books (referenced as a pathway via public-facing content and curriculum pages), history as integrated within a liberal-arts frame. - Negative keywords: explicit “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” phrases are not consistently visible in the scraped public text, though the curriculum architecture suggests alignment with those ideas via Trivium/Great Conversation framing on internal pages. The visible material does not always show direct Great Books engagement in the public snippets.

Why this rating - The curriculum strongly signals classical content (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; philosophy; classic literature) and liberal-arts integration, but the explicit, consistent public articulation of Great Books/-Great Conversation and formal history-as-a-curricular throughlines is not as overt in the accessible public

material as in a full Great-Books program. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than CLASSICAL, pending fuller public confirmation of Great Books engagement.

What would move the needle - Publicly foreground Great Books as a consistent core with “the Great Conversation” framing across grades, and specify historical breadth through primary-source engagement. - More explicit inclusion of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as visible, stage-based curriculum milestones (with examples of student work and assessment).

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Technology-free classrooms are highlighted as part of the Founders Difference, suggesting a contemplative and focused environment. - The site publishes a Trivium-focused framework (via “Trivium Explained” link), indicating attention to the classical pedagogy sequence (grammar/logic/rhetoric). - The presence of lower- and upper-school structures implies a progression toward Socratic and rhetorical training in higher grades (as per classical pedagogy norms), though explicit statements of Socratic seminars or formal dialectic discussions are not heavily foregrounded in the public text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé/restful learning signals (technology-free environment), Socratic dialogue (implied by Trivium focus), rhetoric and oratory (via Trivium), memorization/recitation (via classical pedagogy lineage) though not always explicitly labeled in public text. - Negative keywords: explicit emphasis on project-based/experiential-only pedagogy is not evident in the public materials; the presence of a technology-free, contemplative approach suggests some non-rigorous/narrow pedagogy signals, but without strong contradiction. The public text does not strongly emphasize pure modern constructivist/project-based pedagogy.

Why this rating - The public materials show classical pedagogy signals (Trivium framing, contemplative environment via tech-free classrooms) but lack explicit, consistent documentation of full Socratic seminars or a comprehensive program of mindfulness-based scholé days in a public-facing, grade-by-grade manner. This makes the pedagogy grade SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Publicly articulate a fuller, explicit pedagogy map: confirm and describe regular Socratic seminars or dialectic discussions in upper grades; describe formal memory work, recitation, and chanted/pedagogical repetition in early grades; provide sample lesson structures that embody scholé days and contemplative cycles.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site references a Headmaster (Brooks McDonald) and a culture of high standards in moral character and intellectual discipline, implying teacher exemplarity and mentorship. - Language about a “living curriculum” and “peers and faculty who uphold high standards of moral character and intellectual discipline” signals teachers as models and core constituents of the school’s ethos. - The presence of “Our Educators” page in the site navigation (and the explicit callout to teacher leadership) suggests a cultivated faculty culture and development path.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty as core of school; professional alignment with virtue and wisdom. - Negative keywords: none clearly visible in public materials (no mention of a purely utilitarian, non-mentoring faculty approach).

Why this rating - The explicit citation of a named headmaster, coupled with language about virtue, character, and a living curriculum, supports CLASSICAL for the faculty category. The materials emphasize teachers as moral exemplars and mentors, which aligns with classical expectations for faculty.

What would move the needle - Add explicit statements about faculty formation paths (professional development grounded in classical pedagogy, ongoing seminars for faculty, teacher portraits/character profiles) to strengthen the living-curriculum concept in visible terms.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize partnership with parents and community as co-educators, a central classical pattern. - The materials describe a culture of parental involvement and collaboration, with communications and opportunities for parents to engage as part of the school community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent involvement, co-educators, home-school collaboration, community of learners, parental formation, parent resources. - Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no signs of treating parents as mere customers or absent family involvement).

Why this rating - The school clearly positions parents and the broader community as integral to the classical project, which aligns strongly with the classical tradition of family partnership and shared mission in education. This strongly supports CLASSICAL for Element 6.

What would move the needle - To reinforce CLASSICAL visibility, publish specific family-formation offerings (book clubs, reading groups on classical education, parent study guides) and more explicit on-site opportunities for parent engagement (visits, volunteer commitments) with concrete examples and schedules.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit theology/theological grounding and liturgical/community practices into public messaging (daily/weekly worship, liturgical calendar, sacred music) to elevate the Metaphysical Foundation to CLASSICAL.
 - Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly foreground Great Books/Great Conversation as a formal and recurrent component across grades, and clearly articulate a grammar-logic-rhetoric progression (Trivium) as a visible curricular spine with sample student work and assessments.
 - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide explicit statements about Socratic seminars, disciplined dialogue, “Scholé” days, and memorization/recitation practices in the public-facing curriculum map, with grade-appropriate examples.
 - Element 5 (Faculty): Strengthen the living-curriculum narrative with concrete faculty development programs anchored in classical pedagogy, portraits of teacher-mentors, and public-facing examples of teacher-student mentorship.
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand on formal parent-education offerings (book studies, faculty-parent events) and a transparent schedule of campus visits, volunteer opportunities, and family-centered rituals that reinforce the home-school partnership.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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